PassFrame
TUITION

The Deepest Place on Earth

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Non-fiction (Science)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Far beneath the surface of the Pacific Ocean lies a place so deep and so dark that sunlight has never once reached it. This is the Mariana Trench, and at its deepest point — known as Challenger Deep — the seabed sits almost eleven kilometres below the waves.

To understand just how deep that is, imagine stacking Mount Everest, the tallest mountain on Earth, on top of itself inside the trench. Even then, there would still be more than two kilometres of water left above its peak.

The pressure at the bottom of the Mariana Trench is extraordinary — more than a thousand times greater than at sea level. For many years, scientists believed nothing could possibly survive down there, crushed under such enormous weight.

They were wrong. Strange, pale creatures have been discovered thriving in the crushing darkness, including a type of shrimp-like animal and even microscopic organisms that seem perfectly at home in conditions that would instantly destroy a human body.

Only a handful of people have ever travelled to the very bottom of the trench, in specially built submarines strong enough to withstand the pressure. Even today, we know more about the surface of the Moon than we do about this hidden world at the bottom of our own ocean.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. In which ocean is the Mariana Trench located?

2. How many times greater is the pressure at the bottom of the trench compared to sea level?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you how much water would remain above Everest if it were placed in the trench.

4. Underline the sentence that shows scientists were proved wrong about life in the trench.

5. What does “thriving” suggest about how the creatures live in the trench?

6. Put these events in order (as presented in the text): strange creatures are discovered / the depth is compared to Mount Everest / submarines are described / the trench is introduced by name.

7. Why might the author have used a comparison most readers can picture, like Mount Everest, instead of just stating the number of kilometres?

8. What kind of vehicle is needed to travel to the very bottom of the trench?

9. Why do you think the pressure would “instantly destroy a human body”?

10. What does the phrase “hidden world” suggest about how the author views the trench?

11. Find and copy a word that means “very small, impossible to see without a microscope”.

12. Write one or two sentences giving your own opinion on why exploring places like the Mariana Trench might be important.